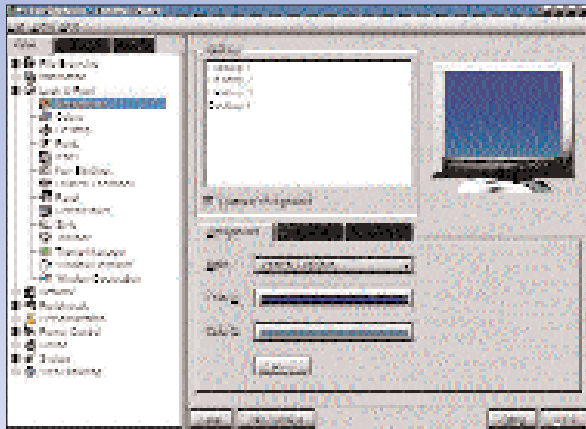




You can give your desktop a personal touch from the KDE Control Center

Using KDE's Control Center we can change the look and feel to the one our eyes desire. To start Control Centre, go to Application Starter > Control Center.

Now click on the Look & Feel item on the left side bar. This will give you the specific option you want to modify.

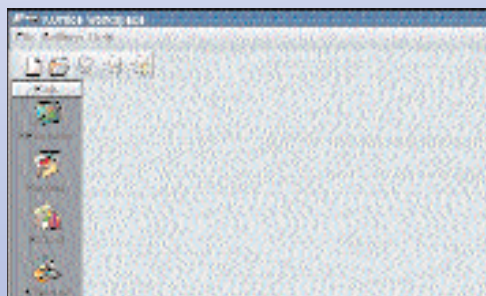
You can change the background colour, colour schemes, etc from the Background and Colors options. Everything connected to the desktop such as desktop properties, appearance and the number of virtual desktops you want to have can be set from the Desktop option.

Changing the look and feel of the panel can be done from the Panel option in Look & Feel. The Panel can also be accessed from Application Starter > Configure Panel if you are in a bit of a hurry.

If you want more flair, check out the Style, Theme Manager, Window Behavior and Window Decoration options as well. Tinkering with these will give you the dream desktop you always wanted.

Work hour

Now that we have the desired look, it's time to get some serious stuff done. For all the text lovers who miss Notepad, KDE has an advanced text editor called Kate, which can be

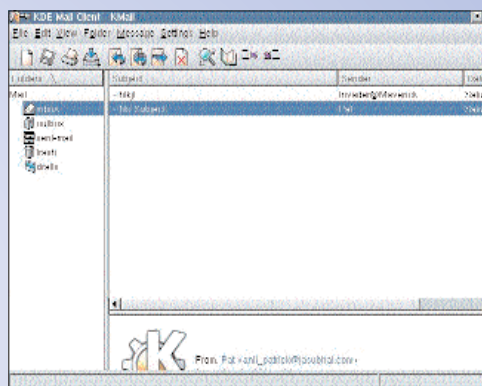


The KOffice Workspace allows you to have a KOffice application embedded within another KOffice application

accessed from Application Starter > Editors > Kate.

You think working in text editors suck? Check out KOffice, KDE's office suite. This office suite has a word processor (KWord), a spread sheet application (KSpread), KPresenter for presentations, etc. You can access KOffice from Application Starter > Office. You can start with one application at a time in KOffice using the individual options in the Office menu.

KOffice has an attractive feature called KParts object model. These are components that allow you to plug in a component made in one KOffice application into another KOffice application. For example, let's say that you



KMail is easy to set up and use, especially for Outlook addicts

want to insert a drawing made in Kontour into a file made in KWord, you can do this using KParts. To do this, you will have start the KOffice Workspace from Application Starter > Office > KOffice Workspace.

KMail is the mail client which comes as standard with KDE. This client is easy to configure and simple to use. Configuring KMail would be a cinch, especially if you've managed to configure Outlook Express before.

Those were the basics of getting KDE to work for you. A word of caution though: although the basic memory required for running the KDE desktop is 64 MB of RAM, it tended to drag a bit on a P-III 500 MHz PC. The performance was somewhat nearer that of Windows 2000 when we increased the RAM to 128 MB, although slightly slower than 2000. But the look and feel is worth having it. Our design team fell head over heels in love with the KDE look.

There you are! Pack your bags and go out with your KDE desktop on new Linux adventures. Linux has become user friendly after all! KDE is one partner who doesn't give up on you. Are you ready?

Adding New Users with KUser

KDE has made adding new users as simple as pie with the KUser tool. This tool allows you to use simple graphical interfaces to add new users without the use of command lines.

To start KUser, click on Application Starter. Now go to System > User Manager. This brings up the Run as root dialog box asking you to login as root. Enter the root password and you get the KDE User Manager—KUser dialog box. To add a new user account you can either click on the Add icon or use User > Add from the menu. Give the name of the account you want to set up. Clicking on OK pops the User Properties dialog box.

It is easy to configure the account using User properties. The User Info tab allows you to set up the user details. The Password Management tab allows you to set up details such as expiry and date of expiry of password. You can specify the particular group that the user belongs to with the Groups tab. Let's say that you are setting up an account called Test. The primary group that Test will belong to is a group with the name Test. You can add this account to as many other groups as required by checking the group you wish Test to be added to.

If you want to modify the properties of a user later on, you can do it with the Edit buttons available in KUser or through User > Edit or after selecting the account. Deleting an account or group can be done using the Del buttons or with User > Delete and Group > Delete. Be sure to save the latest account settings before you exit KUser.